

Poorswani, a senior professional in the mobile development arena, says, “an openness to learn emerging specifications and protocols and application programming languages like Java and XML would be the key requirements.” Be aware of the new standards being developed. If you happen to visit the mobile developer’s/coder’s site, you’ll find lots of everyday listings pertaining to new standards in communication, tips and tricks regarding the same, technical documentation of standards and protocols, and simple software testing tools and emulators which would be handy during the application development process.

Developing Web pages to be displayed on handheld devices and mobile phones is a long-term process. Nowadays, when companies develop Web sites, they prefer to also work out a mobile solution for their site. Content developers can use cHTML, HTML or WML markup languages for developing content. With Microsoft’s Mobile Explorer, one can test Web pages before passing them on to clients. This requires wireless network connectivity. To develop such applications, it is advisable to know about standards of communications and the protocols via which these devices talk to each other.

You might be wondering what operating system these devices would support. The answer is operating systems like Symbian, GEOS and Epoc. Development of applications over these OSes requires better understanding as your development work is for hardware which runs on proprietary or standard operating systems. SyncML, XML, WAP, WML, J2ME and JMS are a few more technologies that you need to know. You could choose the language you are comfortable with or you could make a choice of language and OS based on your application requirement.

Opportunities abound

Now if you are equipped with the required skills, you’d be bubbling with enthusiasm to find out the various career options in this industry. Mobile usage, though slow in India, has been witnessing a progressive growth. You could be an individual developer or you could work for a concern which delivers mobile services. There are three ways you can put forward your application in the market: sell to the mobile operator; sell a patent to a company; or partner with an enterprise solution provider to sell to corporate clients.

As an individual you would always have a problem marketing your application or rolling it into the public domain. It’s more convenient if you are registered with any of those forums or mobile initiatives. A simple reason is that a message posting will make the entire developer community aware of your brand new application floating around. Moreover, these forums are visited by users who check for frequent releases of software, and by company insiders.

Wirelessdevnet.com is a special network. Registering with the site enables you to market your software through the site’s posting services. This network also offers a listing of job providers and job seekers. A registered candidate receives updates on the latest happenings in the wireless world as well as information about the latest vacant positions and requirements.

These, in a nutshell, are the various options and, as pointed out, underlie the enormous potential in the mobile segment. What’s challenging is to develop minimally sized applications and to merge creativity with application development. There’s much money to be made in the wireless world. Don’t stand disconnected. 

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